Summary	Quote
****Advertising**** Only two quotes in the record explicitly connect acquisitions to advertising outcomes. This topic has fewer than 3 qualifying quotes. Sinclair management did not routinely articulate acquisitions in advertising-strategic terms; the two instances that do arise link geographic portfolio positioning (politically competitive markets) and network affiliation gains (NBC affiliate status enabling Olympic advertising revenue) to specific revenue opportunities. Advertising rationale was subordinate to scale and retransmission logic throughout the period.	> "But if you take a look at the trends recently, it obviously will bode well for us because the increases in both political and issue had been astronomical over the last 4 election cycles, whether it be mid-term or presidential. So you couple that with some of the acquisitions that we made that are in some key political battlegrounds, it bodes very well for us. And then, on top of that, another interesting point is that we'll start the year off with a whole host of Super Bowls that will be airing on Fox, which is our biggest affiliate that we're associated with." Steven M. Marks, Vice President and Chief Operating Officer [Aug 2013] > "On the positive, February is benefiting from $8.2 million of incremental Super Bowl revenue which aired on our 31 FOX affiliates as compared to the $2.5 million last year when it aired on our 11 CBS television stations. As the number three NBC affiliate group in the country, we are also pacing for an additional $3.6 million of Olympic revenues which is a revenue stream that we never participated in before but are now able to as a result of the acquisitions. This is important in understanding the tendency of the Olympics as there is distortion of revenue being placed on NBC stations during that term and so much so that the February Nielsen book by many will be discounted in value by advertisers." Steven M. Marks, Vice President and Chief Operating Officer [Feb 2014]
****Local News**** News investment appears in the record as a post-acquisition priority, not a stated acquisition driver. All four qualifying quotes come from a single November 2014 call, after the Barrington, Fisher, Titan, and Allbritton closings. The pattern across groups is consistent: acquired stations had been underfunded on news; Sinclair added personnel, HD cameras, and digital infrastructure after closing. Management framed these investments in revenue terms — improved ratings driving higher revenues — rather than as a public-interest or editorial objective.	> "Thank you, Dave. Since my platform is all new to Sinclair for the most part stations, one of the things I have seen not only on Barrington but on Fisher and Titan and so on groups that we acquired as that in every case we have expanded news holding capacity either to adding hours of news or in almost every case we have increased our market position and our ratings. So what I mean by holding capacity is the amount of rating points we own in news, and in many cases there is still further expansion to be gained in that category." Steve Pruett, Co-COO [Nov 2014] > "So the Barrington in particular had good news positions but they had been underfunded and we have now added personnel, we have done many digital upgrades to HD and digital upgrades. In addition and almost, with the exception of Fisher, in almost every case we have brought in Cox of course, but all the other acquisitions we brought much more advanced digital three and four screen solutions and we continue to grow our digital program which is now based out of Seattle. So we have a lot of positives on that front." Steve Pruett, Co-COO [Nov 2014] > "Yes, and then now with Washington with WJLA, the Allbritton folks they have left us with some great properties but in Washington the focus was on political, but was simply not on WJLA news. And we put our money where our mouth is and just anecdotally we brought in all new cameras for those guys since we acquired just a few weeks ago. So its -- field cameras, that's what I am talking about." David Amy, EVP & COO [Nov 2014]
****Acquisition Criteria**** Sinclair's stated acquisition criteria shifted over the period. In 2013, management described market-type and affiliation preferences: avoiding top-10 markets, building major network exposure, and targeting politically competitive markets. By 2013–2015, the FCC ownership cap emerged as the binding constraint on deal volume, redirecting effort toward structural arrangements within existing markets. By 2018–2019, the emphasis moved to valuation discipline: explicit EBITDA multiple thresholds, with management citing exit from processes where competitors paid prices above their stated floors.	> "And we've historically, and I think that's going to continue, we've avoided becoming a-- and acquiring the top 10 markets, where a lot of the population or a lot of the percentages are gathered. […] And now with our Chesapeake small-market TV station strategy, that gives us even more outlets and more opportunities to acquire than we ever had before. And interestingly enough, it's sort of likely the more we acquire, the stronger we get. The stronger we get, the more we acquire." David B. Amy, Vicepresident and CFO [Apr 2013] > "Marci, with regard to the forward-looking M&A, given that we're essentially at the cap, I think it's safe to say that there's still plenty of work for us to do from the standpoint of creating structures inside marketplaces. A perfect example there is the transaction which we just did in Portland, Maine." David D. Smith, President and CEO [Nov 2013] > "So we have participated in the last couple of processes around the TV broadcast side and they both -- net of going for multiples that were well above our price thresholds to other buyers. And so it's certainly nice to see a very robust M&A market for TV broadcast. I think that's going to have a knock-on effect here for the public players, since the private market is very robust, very high multiples being traded out." Christopher Ripley, President and CEO [Feb 2019]